

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 7 6
♥ 5
♦ A J 10 4
♣ J 8 5 3

♠ K 3 2
♥ A 9 4 2
♦ 9 6 5
♣ K Q 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 5
♥ K Q 10 8 7 6 3
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 9

♠ A J 10 4
♥ J
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ A 7 4 2

West	North	East	South
		3♥	
Pass	3♠		
All Pass			Dbl
3♠ by North			

You dealt this hand.

You make a simple 3♥ opening bid and then the fireworks start. South doubles, your partner passes and North bids 3♠.

Do not preempt the same hand twice. The idea of a preemptive bid is that you bid it's maximum at your first turn. If there is to any further competing on this hand partner will have to do it.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 6 3 2
 ♥ K 8
 ♦ A 9 6 4
 ♣ A 7 3

♠ 10 7
 ♥ A J 10 7 4
 ♦ -
 ♣ K Q 10 9 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 4
 ♥ 6 5 2
 ♦ K Q J 10 8 7 3
 ♣ 8 5

♠ A K Q J 9 5
 ♥ Q 9 3
 ♦ 5 2
 ♣ J 6

West	North	East	South
		3♦	3♠

4♦

All Pass

4♦ by East

The bidding has been as shown.

You do not have the 4 fast winners you need to raise partner to the 4-level. But you do have 4 of his trumps and 2 and a half winners. And your side doesn't have much defense against a 3♠ contract. You should raise partner to 4♦ because you think they can make 3♠. With these hands it appears they might have gone to 4♠ in which case you would have had to decide whether to continue to 5♦. More judgement would be called for, based on Vulnerability, whether you think they can make the game, etc. The Law of Total Tricks can be a help in these competitive situations; it would lead you to 5♦.